

Start here

You don't need to know how. You need to know what to ask. This folder gets you from zero to your first useful result, then your AI assistant takes over as your teacher.

John Huikku

Your first three steps

1. **Install one tool** and sign in. Use the one your subscription includes: **Claude Code** (Claude app), **Codex** (ChatGPT app) or **Antigravity**. No subscription? Codex and Antigravity have free tiers. → *03 Setup Guide*, step 1.
2. **Copy this whole folder to your Documents, then open it in your tool.** The folder *is* your class workspace: your assistant reads its rules and becomes your personal tutor. It asks your level, makes practice files so you never experiment on real footage, and walks you through your first task. (Not inside Google Drive or OneDrive: copy it out first. Using a chat app instead? Paste `mentor-prompt.txt` into a new chat.)
3. **Do one first-week project** (the mentor will suggest one). The easiest: *"List the specs of every clip in this folder. Don't change anything."*

What's in this folder

File	What it's for	When
01 Class 1 Slides	The deck from the class	Refresh your memory
02 Companion Guide	Everything from the class written out, plus the prompt library, glossary and FAQ	Read chapters 1–4 first
03 Setup Guide	Installing your tool, ffmpeg, Python, GitHub, on Windows, Mac or Linux	Before your first session
04 Safety & Your Data	The five habits and what goes to the cloud, on one page	Keep it open
05 Stack Guide	What to use when you build tools and apps	When you're ready to build
<code>AGENTS.md</code> , <code>course.md</code> , skills	Tutor mode, studio rules and skills your assistant loads when you open this folder	Automatic
<code>prompts/</code>	Setup prompts and the prompt library, copy-paste clean	Day one
<code>starter-pack/</code>	The kit you copy into your own project folders	Your first real project

Five habits, in one line each

1. **Work on copies** until you trust the task.
2. **Dry run first:** "show me what you'd change" before anything moves.
3. **Read before you approve.** Keep approvals on.
4. **No passwords, keys or confidential details** in prompts or file names.
5. **Only trusted add-ons.** MCPs and skills run code on your machine.

Stuck? Ask your AI first, every time. *"Explain this like I'm an artist, not a coder."* It's faster, it's there at 2am, and it teaches you as it answers. Tried that and still stuck? Then ask John.